

Daily Economic Briefing

Thursday 24 September 2026 | Window: Tue 22 Sept 20:00 ET → Wed 23 Sept 20:21 ET (session: Wed 23 Sept close/AH) | Research cutoff 23 Sept 20:21 ET | Edition 27

Assumptions, corrections and status this edition

- Correction:** edition 26 reported Tuesday 22 Sept's 2-year Treasury yield as 4.43%. A fresh direct pull from FRED (series DGS2) and the Fed's own H.15, both fetched this run, show **4.71%** for that date ^[19] — treating 4.71% as correct and superseding the prior figure. Wednesday's own 2-year close could not be corroborated (a Treasury.gov figure of 4.10% is arithmetically implausible against this base and is discarded — see Annex A).
- Open thread resolved:** the Philadelphia Fed Nonmanufacturing Business Outlook Survey, marked unavailable at edition 26 due to conflicting aggregator figures, is now confirmed via a direct philadelphiafed.org fetch: it released **Tuesday 22 Sept** (not Wednesday) with a Regional Activity Index of **-22.0** ^[22]. Carried here as a correction to Tuesday's record, not new Wednesday flow.
- SNB decision date revised:** edition 26 carried Friday 25 Sept as the best-supported date. Fresh sourcing this run — the SNB's established Thursday cadence for its last three assessments, plus a dated FXStreet preview quoting a "September 24" meeting — now points to **Thursday 24 Sept** instead, alongside Norges Bank, Riksbank and Banxico ^[23]. Still not confirmed directly against snb.ch (see Annex A).
- Sourcing note:** WTI's front-month contract rolled from October (Tuesday's expiring settle, \$94.59) to November this session. Wednesday's \$92.16 November print is compared against Tuesday's November close (\$90.52), not the expired October contract — a straight October-to-Wednesday comparison would show a misleading decline that is actually just the roll gap.
- Kalshi's October-hike-odds market failed direct fetch (HTTP 429) for a fifth consecutive edition; no usable cached fallback was found this time either — marked unavailable rather than estimated.
- CBOE's volatility delayed-quote feed served entirely stale Tuesday data across all six series this run (VIX, VIX9D, VIX3M, VIX6M, VVIX, SKEW) — a step beyond the usual "thin-series-stale" pattern. Wednesday's VIX close is sourced from news coverage instead (single-sourced); the other five series are unavailable for Wednesday.
- A stale-date trap was caught and discarded: a Wednesday-dated aggregator article reproduced Tuesday's exact index levels and bank-stock story (Schwab, Ameriprise) under a Wednesday URL. That bank-selloff detail belongs to Tuesday (already reported last edition) and is not repeated here.

60-second read

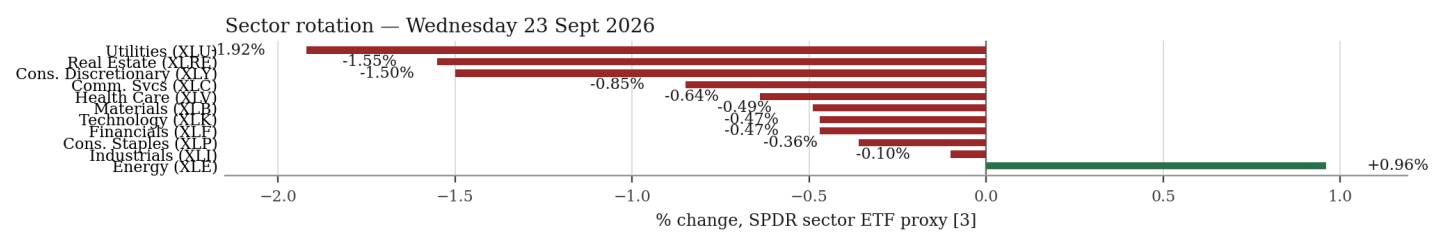
- A broad risk-off session: S&P 500 -0.75% to 7,706.03, Dow -0.68% to 51,511.59, Nasdaq -1.13% to 26,936.04, Russell 2000 -1.77% to 2,838.66 ^{[1][2]} — the trigger was the 10-year Treasury yield spiking to approx. 5.09-5.14% intraday, its highest since 2007, after a red-hot flash composite PMI and hawkish Fed commentary revived October-hike fears.
- The "Meta Muse" AI-agent disintermediation theme rotated from Tuesday's banks into online travel agencies: Expedia -7.72%, Airbnb -7.56%, Booking Holdings -5.07%, while Meta itself rose +1.02% as the AI distributor and got a Cantor Fitzgerald price-target raise to \$860. A Goldman Sachs trading-desk note extended the thesis to financials, insurance and telecom.
- Paychex fell -8.77% despite topline and adjusted-EPS beats, on GAAP-vs-adjusted earnings-quality concerns and weak free cash flow; Cracker Barrel rose +4.49% on a big EPS beat and a reassuring FY2027 outlook.
- Megacap tech was hit by the yield spike with no company-specific news: Alphabet -3.80%, Amazon -2.24% — a duration/rate-sensitivity de-rating, not an earnings or guidance story.
- Energy was the only S&P sector to close higher (XLE +0.96%) as Brent jumped +3.86% to \$103.08, snapping a five-session losing streak after Iran's president told the UN Iran "cannot be made to surrender" — VIX jumped +6.83% to 15.18 on the day's broad de-risking.

1. Market recap

S&P 500 7,706.03 -0.75%	Dow Jones 51,511.59 -0.68%	Nasdaq Comp. 26,936.04 -1.13%	Russell 2000 2,838.66 -1.77%	VIX 15.18 +6.83%	10-yr Treasury approx. 5.10% 19-yr high
DXY 101.10 +0.53%	Brent \$103.08 +3.86%				

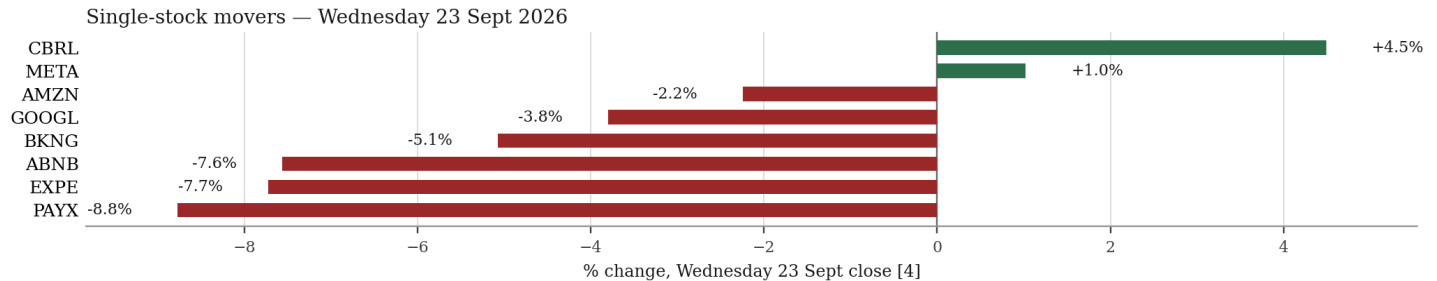
All four major indices closed lower Wednesday, confirmed via two independently agreeing wire sources (AP and Reuters) after both wires had failed to post in time for Tuesday's session in the prior two editions ^{[1][2]}. Breadth was weak: Reuters put decliners ahead of advancers roughly 1.9-to-1, and AP noted more than 72% of issues fell ^[2]. The proximate trigger was a jump in long-end yields — the 10-year hit its highest level since July 2007 — after S&P Global's flash September composite PMI printed at 58.4, the strongest private-sector expansion reading since July 2021, and Fed Governor Michael Barr said in a Chicago speech that inflation is "not clearly trending toward target" and further tightening "is likely to be needed" ^{[20][21]}. Energy alone closed higher as oil snapped a five-day losing streak on renewed Iran-related risk premium.

2. Equities and earnings



Sector rotation flipped from Tuesday's financials-led selloff to a broad, rate-driven decline led by rate-sensitive groups: Utilities (XLU -1.92%) and Real Estate (XLRE -1.55%) were the worst performers as the yield spike hit bond-proxy sectors, with Consumer Discretionary (XLY -1.50%) dragged lower by the travel names below. Financials (XLF -0.47%) stabilized after Tuesday's -1.97% rout rather than extending it, and Materials (XLB -0.49%), Tuesday's leader, fell back in line with the market. Energy (XLE +0.96%) was the sole positive sector on the oil rally ^[3]. (AP's GICS sector-index commentary put utilities at -1.72% and communication services at -1.49% — a normal index-vs-ETF-price methodology gap from the SPDR figures used above, not a data conflict ^[2].)

Single-stock movers



Ticker	Move	Driver
Paychex (PAYX)	-8.77%	FQ1 beat on revenue/adj. EPS, but GAAP EPS \$1.21 well below the \$1.34 adjusted figure and weak free cash flow raised earnings-quality concerns ^{[4][5][6]}
Expedia (EXPE)	-7.72%	"Muse" AI-shopping-agent disintermediation fear for online travel agencies ^{[4][10]}
Airbnb (ABNB)	-7.56%	Same Muse-disintermediation theme ^{[4][10]}
Booking Holdings (BKNG)	-5.07%	Same theme; compounds Morgan Stanley's 16 Sept Underweight call and the EU's 9 Sept ETraveli-block ruling ^{[4][10]}
Alphabet (GOOGL)	-3.80%	No company news — duration/rate-sensitivity de-rating of high-multiple megacaps on the yield spike ^{[4][11]}
Amazon (AMZN)	-2.24%	Same yield-driven de-rating ^{[4][11]}
Meta Platforms (META)	+1.02%	Muse-driven beneficiary framing; Cantor Fitzgerald raised its price target to \$860 (Overweight) ^{[4][8]}
Cracker Barrel (CBRL)	+4.49%	Q4/FY26 adjusted EPS \$0.99 vs. approx. \$0.26 consensus; reassuring FY2027 revenue and EBITDA outlook ^{[4][7]}

Earnings and analyst actions

Paychex (fiscal Q1 2027, reported before the open): adjusted EPS \$1.34 (beat approx. \$1.32-1.33 consensus), revenue \$1.631bn (beat, +6% y/y), full-year guidance reaffirmed — but GAAP EPS of \$1.21 and free cash flow down sharply y/y (just 87% of net income) drove the stock lower despite the headline beat ^{[5][6]}. **Cracker Barrel** (Q4/FY2026): revenue \$849.3m (-2.2% y/y, beat approx. \$845m consensus); comparable restaurant sales -2.1%, comparable retail sales +0.7%; FY2027 guidance of \$3.325-3.4bn revenue, 3-5% comp-restaurant growth, \$180-200m adjusted EBITDA ^[7].

Analyst actions named Wednesday: Cantor Fitzgerald raised Meta to a \$860 price target (Overweight), citing Muse's approx. \$1 trillion addressable-market potential ^[8]. Rating changes confirmed by direction only (dollar price targets not obtained — see Annex A): Stifel upgraded Microsoft to Buy; JPMorgan upgraded BP to Overweight and downgraded TotalEnergies to Neutral; Guggenheim upgraded Editas Medicine to Buy; UBS initiated CoreWeave at Buy and downgraded PG&E to Neutral; Citi downgraded Smiths Group to Neutral; Raymond James downgraded Baldwin Group to Underperform ^[9].

The Muse-disintermediation theme, which hit banks and wealth managers Tuesday, rotated into online travel agencies Wednesday rather than fading. A Goldman Sachs trading-desk note explicitly warned that "industries built on recurring bills, add-on charges and customer passivity face significant disruption" from AI agents of this kind, extending the thesis beyond travel to financials, insurance and telecom ^[10] — corroborating the framing this report flagged as paywalled and unconfirmed last edition; that thread is now closed.

3. Macro, policy and rates

Fed Chair Kevin Warsh was re-confirmed fresh against the Fed's own Board of Governors page, and the next FOMC meeting remains October 27-28, 2026 per the Fed's own calendar ^{[12][13]}. October-hike odds converged somewhat into the mid-50s: Polymarket approx. 54-56% hike (up modestly from approx. 53%) and CME FedWatch secondary citations approx. 54-55.1%, versus a wider approx. 53-60% range carried in recent editions; Kalshi failed direct fetch a fifth straight edition with no usable cached fallback ^{[14][15]}.

Wednesday's dominant macro print was S&P Global's flash September PMI: composite 58.4 (up from 56.0, strongest since July 2021), manufacturing 57.0 (from 53.9), services 58.7 (from 56.5) — with input-cost inflation at its highest since October 2022 ^[21]. Fed Governor Michael Barr, speaking at a Chicago Fed community-development summit, said inflation risks have risen while labor-market risks have receded and "further policy adjustments are likely to be needed," backing the Committee's 16 Sept hike ^[20]. The 10-year Treasury yield spiked to a 19-year high; sources range approx. 5.09% (Reuters) to approx. 5.14% (a Wednesday live-markets recap), with AP and CNBC both near 5.10-5.11% ^{[2][18]} — reported as a range rather than a single print given the spread. Tuesday's 2-year close is corrected to 4.71% (see disclosure box); Wednesday's 2-year could not be verified. SOFR's most recent published reading (effective Tuesday 22 Sept, T+1 lag) was 3.87%, up from 3.85%; Wednesday's reading posts Thursday ^[19].

Separately, the Philadelphia Fed's Nonmanufacturing Business Outlook (Tuesday 22 Sept release, previously unresolved) is now confirmed at a Regional Activity Index of -22.0, the weakest since June ^[22]. On trade, the Canada import-ban escalation (from 50% tariffs to outright bans on dairy, alcohol, motorcycles/mopeds and molasses) remains on track for 29 Sept, unchanged from prior editions. The Trump-Xi Washington summit continued its opening day: Trump personally greeted Xi and Peng Liyuan at Joint Base Andrews, and Treasury Secretary Bessent met Chinese Vice Premier He Lifeng ahead of Thursday's main bilateral meeting, military ceremony and

state dinner ^[24]. Thursday also brings a four-way central-bank cluster — Norges Bank, Riksbank and Banxico were already scheduled, and the SNB's date now looks to have moved up to the same day (see disclosure box) ^{[16][17][23]}; Banxico's own consensus (a Citi survey of 36 analysts) points to a hold at 6.50%, 25-to-11.

4. Commodities and FX

Instrument	Level	Chg	Note
Brent crude	\$103.08/bbl	+3.86%	Snapped a 5-session losing streak on Iran UNGA rhetoric ^[25]
WTI crude (Nov)	\$92.16/bbl	+1.81%	Front-month rolled Oct → Nov this session; vs. Tue Nov close \$90.52, not the expired Oct \$94.59 settle ^[26]
Gold (Kitco)	approx. \$4,297.53/oz	approx. -1.4%	vs. Tue Kitco baseline \$4,358.80; genuine vendor split persists (below)
Gold (USAGOLD)	\$4,304.11/oz	approx. -0.08%	vs. Tue USAGOLD baseline \$4,307.63 ^[27]
Silver	approx. \$63.98-64.53/oz	approx. -1.1% to -2.0%	Range across intraday timestamps; no single clean close obtained ^[28]
Copper (LME cash)	\$14,735.00/t	-0.42%	Via Westmetal; lme.com/metal.com both skipped (6-for-6 fail streak) ^[29]
DXY	approx. 101.10	+0.53%	Highest since late July, on hawkish-Fed repricing ^[30]
EUR/USD	1.1448	-0.15%	^[31]
GBP/USD	1.3343	-0.21%	^[31]
USD/JPY	157.464	+0.06%	Continued mild post-BoJ yen weakness ^[31]

Oil moved in two acts: an early slide extended Tuesday's losses below \$99 on Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline restart and a larger-than-expected weekly US crude build (reported variously as approx. 1.7-3.0m barrels, magnitude unresolved — see Annex A), then reversed sharply after Iranian President Pezeshkian told the UN General Assembly Iran "cannot be made to surrender," reviving Hormuz-risk pricing ^[25]. Gold's vendor split narrowed versus Tuesday (Kitco and USAGOLD are now roughly \$7 apart, versus approx. \$50 on Tuesday) but the two vendors still imply very different day-over-day changes because each is measured against its own prior-day baseline; COMEX December futures opened up approx. 0.4% but no clean settlement print was obtained ^{[27][28]}. The dollar's DXY gain of +0.53% looks large relative to the -0.15%/-0.21% moves in EUR/USD and GBP/USD, a magnitude gap that could not be fully reconciled within this window and is flagged rather than smoothed over.

5. Derivatives, volatility and positioning

The CBOE delayed-quotes feed served entirely stale Tuesday data across all six volatility series this run (a step beyond the usual "thin-series-stale" pattern) — every `last\_trade\_time` stamp read Tuesday's close. VIX's Wednesday close of **15.18 (+6.83%)**, computed manually against Tuesday's logged 14.21, is therefore sourced from news coverage only and treated as single-sourced ^[32]; VIX9D, VIX3M, VIX6M, VVIX and SKEW are unavailable for Wednesday (Annex A). Cboe's options-statistics page showed VIX total volume of 902,421 contracts — genuinely different from Tuesday's stale-duplicate 713,342, so it clears the "not a repeat" bar this time, though the page still carries no explicit date stamp, so confidence is moderate ^[33].

SpotGamma's own site again returned only boilerplate with no usable figure, a fifth straight failed edition. A third-party tool, zerogex.io, gave a fresh, dated alternative: net SPX gamma exposure of approx. +\$9.47bn (a positive-gamma regime) with a flip level of 7,685 against Wednesday's 7,706 close — a plausible, self-consistent read, reported as single-sourced ^[34]. CFTC's Commitments of Traders report remains dated 15 Sept (published 18 Sept), confirmed via a direct cftc.gov fetch, with the next update due approx. Friday 25 Sept — that report postdates this window ^[35]. SOFR's most recent published print is Tuesday's 3.87%; Wednesday's reading posts Thursday under the standard T+1 lag ^[19].

6. The day ahead

Date	Event	Consensus / context
Thu 24 Sept	Norges Bank rate decision	Prior held at 4.25% since 12 Aug; desk previews split hold vs. 25bp hike ^[16]
Thu 24 Sept	Riksbank rate decision	New rate to apply from 30 Sept per the bank's own framing ^[17]
Thu 24 Sept	Banxico rate decision, 13:00 CT	Citi survey: 25 of 36 analysts expect a hold at 6.50% ^[23]
Thu 24 Sept (likely)	SNB rate decision	Date revised from Fri 25 Sept; consensus expects a hold at 0.00% (not yet snb.ch-confirmed) ^[23]
Thu 24 Sept	Trump-Xi bilateral meeting, state dinner	Trade, AI, critical minerals, rare earths and Taiwan on the agenda ^[24]
Thu 24 Sept	Initial jobless claims; housing starts/permits	Secondary-calendar sourced, not primary-confirmed this run
Fri 25 Sept	Durable goods orders; CFTC CoT weekly report	CoT next due approx. this date ^[35]

Sector setup we take into Thursday

- Energy has a tailwind if Iran-related risk premium persists into Thursday's session; watch Brent follow-through above \$103.
- Online travel names (Expedia, Airbnb, Booking) remain exposed to further Muse-disintermediation headlines; Meta is the cleanest expressed beneficiary so far.
- Rate-sensitive groups — utilities, real estate, staples — stay vulnerable if the 10-year holds above 5%; a reversal in yields would be the more likely catalyst for a bounce than any single-stock news.
- Financials head into Thursday's four-way central-bank cluster (Norges Bank, Riksbank, Banxico, likely SNB) already having stabilized from Tuesday's rout — a hawkish surprise from any of the four could reintroduce volatility there.

Annex A — Data points sought but not verified this edition

- Kalshi October-hike-odds market: HTTP 429 for a fifth consecutive edition; no usable cached snippet found.
- SNB's exact decision date: best-supported as Thu 24 Sept via secondary sourcing, but no successful direct snb.ch fetch (404s on attempted URLs).
- Wednesday's 2-year Treasury close: a Treasury.gov TextView read of 4.10% is inconsistent with the corrected Tuesday base of 4.71% and could not be corroborated; discarded.
- VIX9D, VIX3M, VIX6M, VVIX, SKEW for Wednesday: CBOE feed served entirely stale (Tuesday) data; no secondary source found for these five series.
- Exact weekly EIA crude inventory build: sources ranged approx. 1.7-3.0m barrels; direction agreed, magnitude did not reconcile.
- Dollar-figure price targets for Wednesday's non-Meta analyst actions (Stifel/MSFT, JPMorgan/BP and TotalEnergies, Guggenheim/EDIT, UBS/CRWV and PG&E, Citi/Smiths Group, Raymond James/Baldwin Group): rating direction confirmed, PT levels not obtained.
- A single definitive NY-close COMEX gold futures settlement for Wednesday: only scattered intraday reads (approx. \$4,285-4,395) were obtained.
- Wednesday-specific Uber/Lyft stock moves tied to the Muse theme: only Tuesday data could be confirmed.
- Thursday's initial jobless claims and housing starts/permits: sourced only from secondary economic-calendar aggregators, not a primary BLS/Census calendar fetch.
- AP's precise sector-index percentages for Wednesday beyond the two cited (utilities, communication services): not obtained in full.

Annex B — Sources

- [1] AP wire via ABC News, "How major US stock indexes fared," 23 Sept 2026
- [2] Reuters wire via Honolulu Star-Advertiser, "Wall Street ends down as oil prices, Treasury yields rise," 23 Sept 2026
- [3] Stockanalysis.com SPDR sector ETF price-history pages (XLE, XLF, XLK, XLB, XLC, XLY, XLP, XLRE, XLI, XLU, XLV), 23 Sept 2026 close
- [4] Stockanalysis.com single-stock closing-price pages (EXPE, ABNB, BKNG, PAYX, CBRL, GOOGL, AMZN, META), 23 Sept 2026 close
- [5] Paychex press release via GlobeNewswire, "Paychex Reports First Quarter Fiscal 2027 Results," 23 Sept 2026
- [6] The Motley Fool, "Why Paychex Stock Dropped Today," 23 Sept 2026.
- [7] Cracker Barrel Q4/FY2026 press release (8-K exhibit via SEC EDGAR), 23 Sept 2026
- [8] MarketBeat / Investing.com, Cantor Fitzgerald Meta Platforms price-target note, 23 Sept 2026
- [9] Daily Trade Alert, "Analyst Upgrades and Downgrades for Wednesday, 9/23," 23 Sept 2026
- [10] 24/7 Wall St., "Travel Booking Stocks Tumble as Muse Threatens to Bypass Them," 23 Sept 2026
- [11] Benzinga, "Nasdaq 100 Slips, 10-Year Yields Hit 19-Year Highs," 23 Sept 2026
- [12] Federal Reserve Board of Governors, official bios page, fetched 23 Sept 2026
- [13] Federal Reserve, FOMC meeting calendar, fetched 23 Sept 2026
- [14] Polymarket, "Fed decision in October" market, fetched 23 Sept 2026
- [15] Phemex, CME FedWatch probability reporting, 23 Sept 2026
- [16] Norges Bank, policy-rate decision calendar page (26-09-24), fetched 23 Sept 2026
- [17] Newsquawk, "Riksbank Policy Announcement on 24th September 2026," preview
- [18] Yahoo Finance, live markets blog, "Dow, S&P 500, Nasdaq tumble as 10-year Treasury yield surges to 2007 high," 23 Sept 2026
- [19] FRED (fred.stlouisfed.org), series DGS10/DGS2/SOFR, cross-checked against Federal Reserve H.15, fetched 23 Sept 2026
- [20] Federal Reserve, Governor Michael Barr speech text, "A Long-Term View on the Costs of Shelter," 23 Sept 2026
- [21] S&P Global, US flash PMI press release, 23 Sept 2026
- [22] Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia, Nonmanufacturing Business Outlook Survey, September 2026
- [23] Rio Times / elcongresista.mx (Banxico); FXStreet SNB preview quoting DBS economist Philip Wee, 23 Sept 2026
- [24] NBC News / The National, Trump-Xi Washington summit coverage, 23 Sept 2026
- [25] CNBC, "Oil prices rise, snap five day losing streak as Iran vows it will not surrender," 23 Sept 2026
- [26] Investing.com, WTI crude historical data (November contract), fetched 23 Sept 2026
- [27] USAGOLD, daily gold price history, 23 Sept 2026
- [28] Kitco, live gold and silver charts, 23 Sept 2026
- [29] Westmetall.com, LME copper cash settlement tables, 23 Sept 2026
- [30] Trading Economics, US Dollar Index, fetched 23 Sept 2026; cross-checked against Investing.com
- [31] Yahoo Finance, EUR/USD, GBP/USD and USD/JPY historical quote pages, 23 Sept 2026
- [32] Yahoo Finance, live markets blog (VIX close), 23 Sept 2026
- [33] Cboe, US Options Daily Market Statistics page, fetched 23 Sept 2026
- [34] zerogex.io, SPX gamma-exposure levels, fetched 23 Sept 2026, approx. 3:59pm ET print
- [35] CFTC, Commitments of Traders report page, fetched 23 Sept 2026

Method: every figure traces to a named source in Annex B; where sources disagreed, the better-corroborated figure was used and the conflict disclosed. Nothing estimated or filled from memory — unverifiable items are listed in Annex A. Not investment advice.